



UNDERGRADUATE ACADEMIC REGULATIONS

DEANSHIP OF ADMISSION, REGISTRATION,
AND STUDENT AFFAIRS (DARSA)



dh_university

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VICE CHANCELLOR MESSAGE

Dear Readers

Rules and regulations are omnipresent as they help govern and establish a good system. Educational system too is governed by a set of academic rules and regulations which help support smooth academic journeys in any higher education Institution. Usually students journey through the undergraduate programs is one of great ecstasy, exploration, self-discovery and knowledge attainment.

At Dhofar University (DU) we ensure that the students' academic journey is smooth in their pursuit for knowledge. The Undergraduate (UG) academic regulations help to impart the basic information about the conduct of the academic programs, plan of study, role of advisor, entry requirements, registration rules and procedures and graduation requirements to support DU UG students to complete the programs enrolled within the time frame and with high academic achievements. Therefore, careful reading and understanding of the regulations is essential to maintain a smooth path of study in the University.

A copy of the DU Undergraduate Regulations are available for download from the DU website and the Deanship of Admission and Registration and Student's Affairs (DARSA) is responsible for its implementation. Students can approach the Dean of DARSA for support, clarifications and implementation of these regulations. I will advise all DU Undergraduate students to keep a copy of the regulations for easy reference and clarification.

DU faculty roles are the most crucial in the implementation of the regulations as they have multiple role to play as instructors, academic advisors and mentors. I would like to stress that compliance with all processes, procedures and rules given in the UG Academic Regulations is very imperative for the academic success and fruitful journey of your students. Faculty has the responsibility to sensitize and make aware students of the academic regulations and encourage them to understand and comply with them for a smooth academic journey.

May Allah Guide you to success

Prof. Amer Ali Al Rawas

Vice Chancellor

THE UNIVERSITY

Background

Dhofar University (DU) is a private institution of higher education in Salalah, Sultanate of Oman, established by Ministerial Decree No. 5/2004 issued in January 2004. The University formally commenced its operations in September 2004. DU has a Board of Trustees that represents its highest policy-making body.

Location and Climate

Being in Salalah, the University community enjoys the well-known geographic beauty of Dhofar region and the mild weather throughout the year particularly in the Summer, which is locally known as Khareef. The temperature remains steady in the upper twenties, with occasional rise to mid-thirties. The long and clean sandy shores of Salalah, one of the most beautiful in the world, are ideal for fishing and swimming. The nearby mountains are ideal for hiking.

Campus Facilities

DU campus is designed to conform to local needs and cultural context while meeting both international design standards and those of the Ministry of Higher Education, Research and Innovation (MoHERI). The campus includes an administration building, three buildings for the four colleges and the Centre for Preparatory Studies (CPS), a common classroom building, a library building, a student activities center, a conference hall, a mosque, female student residency, a student counseling center, using for the senior administration and an engineering workshop.

Vision

Dhofar University aspires to occupy a distinct position among the leading institutions of higher education in the Arab Region.

Mission

To provide quality teaching and learning, conduct research in an inspiring environment conducive to creativity and innovation, and engage with the community.

Core Values

The core values of DU are:

- Excellence – Our commitment to excellence drives us to do better consistently.
- Integrity – We believe in honesty and coherence between our words and actions.
- Responsibility – We accept full responsibility for our actions all the time.
- Commitment – We are committed to give our best and deliver what we promise.
- Transparency – For us, transparency is the foundation of trust.
- Adaptability – We believe adaptability is the key to success in an ever-changing environment.

Graduate Attributes

The graduate attributes of DU are:

- 1) Master theoretical knowledge and practical skills in the students' chosen discipline commensurate with program level and objectives.
- 2) Demonstrate capacity for effective communication, critical thinking, creativity and innovation.
- 3) Exhibit honesty, discipline and accountability.
- 4) Practice tolerance, humility, respect for differences and commitment to service.
- 5) Practice life-long learning.

Deanship of Admission, Registration and Student Affairs

The Deanship for Admission and Registration and student affairs (DARSA) is responsible for facilitating the admission of new students, registration process of continuing students and is the custodian and implementation authority for all undergraduate academic regulations. The deanship actively engages with MOHERI in terms of scholarships, academic programs approvals and implementation of its ministerial decisions, directives and guidelines about academic conduct, scholarships and other academic issues.

There are three departments under the DARSA. These are:

1. Department of Admission and Registration (DAR),
2. Department of Student Affairs (DSA) and
3. Department of Female Student Residency (DFSR).

Each of these departments is headed by a director who has a set of authorities and responsibilities that enables him/her achieving the objectives of his/her concerned department.

Academic Units

Dhofar University (DU) has four Colleges and a Centre for Preparatory Studies:

1. College of Arts and Applied Sciences (CAAS),
2. College of Commerce and Business Administration (CCBA),
3. College of Engineering (CE),
4. College of Law (CL), and
5. Centre for Preparatory Studies (CPS).

The Centre for Preparatory Studies (CPS) delivers the Foundation Program (FP) that is designed to bridge the gap between secondary education and university undergraduate studies of DU students.

Academic Undergraduate programs

DU offers several Undergraduate Academic Programs at Two levels

1. Diploma Programs
2. Bachelor's Programs

Academic Programs follow the American model of higher education and use English as the medium of instruction, but some programs are also delivered in Arabic. The academic year is divided into two semesters of sixteen weeks of instruction each, and a Summer term of eight weeks of instruction (it delivers the same number of contact hours as in the regular semester).

A student is awarded either a Diploma or a Bachelor's degree, in accordance with the choice he/she made when he/she joined DU.

If a Bachelor bound student decided, for a legitimate reason, to forgo his/her desire to finish the Bachelor Program in the middle of a semester and decided to receive a diploma instead, then he/she may decide to drop all courses in progress pertaining to the Bachelor program. A Diploma will then be awarded contingent to completing the requirements of the Diploma Program, subject to the approval of the College Council. However, scholarship students will need to have the approval of their sponsor before changing their degree. A student can progress to his/her major in the College only after successfully completing all FP requirements (English, Mathematics and Information Technology).

The Undergraduate Programs offered in each college are listed on the DU website. ([Programs and Degrees Offered | Dhofar University \(du.edu.om\)](https://du.edu.om))

Plan of Study

Each degree program has a plan of study (PoS) specifying all degree requirements for completing the program and graduating. The PoS shows the courses, their codes, levels and credits. The PoS is presented in two formats to help students follow their study path towards graduation smoothly. One PoS format is based on courses that should be completed by students, semester by semester, and the other is based on the course category. Both formats are accessible to students and their academic advisors via the DU student information system (LogSIS). Whilst the semester-wise format guides students to move efficiently semester by semester, the course category enables students to know their completion of their courses within their categories, these are: the university requirements, the college requirements, the major requirements, and the elective requirements. It is a determinant factor that students follow their PoS as provided semester by semester to avoid any delay or schedule and final exam conflicts.

Course Code and Description

All DU courses have a specific code each specifying the level and discipline and include a course description to provide an idea about the content coverage of the course. In addition, the course description provides the courses that should precede them (pre-requisites) and the courses that should be studied along with them (co-requisites).

Academic Advising

Academic advising is designed to provide the necessary tools, information, and support to enable students to take responsibility for: developing and maintaining educational plans compatible with their personal, academic, and professional goals; meeting institutional and degree requirements; and preparing for a life of change, challenge, individual fulfillment, active citizenship, and public service.

Academic Advisor

Each student is assigned to an academic advisor at DU. The academic advisor is a faculty member in the academic department in which the student is enrolled. The role of the academic advisor is to assist the advisee in preparing course schedule during registration, support and guide him/her during the university studies, monitor the academic progress, and offer counselling on any academic difficulties or problems the student may experience.

The main role of the academic advisor is to ensure the student compliance with his/her PoS in a timely manner while maintaining the academic standards required for graduation. For this, students must seek their academic advisors' consultancy on the courses to register in the coming semester anytime during the semester or right after the results are released. Students will have to acknowledge doing so to be able to register online.

DU Student Information System

DU offers all its students access to self-information to enable students to have access to all their academic information, register courses, drop and add courses, file petition, know the grades of all courses and his transcript, dues and payments information as well as a platform for online communication with all stakeholders of the university. The Student Information System (SIS) is linked to the online learning Management system MOODLE for all kinds of academic communication. Any students once enrolled as a DU students can apply to the center for networking and Computing for a login to the SIS portal available on the web. DU SIS system could be accessed remotely and hence provide the students with all information even if she/he is not physically available on campus. The SIS system can be accessed through the DU website [Log In \(du.edu.om\)](https://du.edu.om)

DU e-Mail

DU has an email system to maximize communication effectiveness among its internal user groups (students, faculty, and staff). DU email is a formal communication channel of the university with its internal and external stakeholders. Hence, DU students are strongly advised to access their DU email accounts on a daily basis to track their absences, along with the other important things, to respond appropriately when needed.

PART A - ADMISSION

Admission Requirements

- 1) Students are admitted to the undergraduate Programs based on their:
 - a) General Education Diploma Certificate or its equivalent; and
 - b) Results of the English, Mathematics and IT placement tests conducted by DU CPS.
- 2) Based on the results of placement tests, accepted students are divided into two groups as follows:
 - a) Students who need remedial work will join the CPS, for one or more semesters, until they successfully complete the Foundation Program; and
 - b) Students who are ready proceed directly to the first year of the Diploma or Bachelor's Program.
- 3) Students may be exempted from English, Mathematics or IT Foundation requirements and admitted directly to their chosen fields of specialization if they meet the following criteria:
 - a) Exemption from English requires a minimum score of 50 on the Cambridge English Placement Test (CEPT), or a minimum score of 5 in IELTS, or a minimum of 500 in TOEFL.
 - b) Exemption from Mathematics requires a minimum score of 60 on the Moodle-based Math Placement Test.
 - c) Exemption from IT requires a minimum score of 70 in the Moodle-based IT Placement test or an International (English) IC3 certificate. In the case of the provision of a domestic (Arabic) IC3 certificate, students shall be required to take an IT Challenge Test and score a minimum of 60% to clear IT.

Applicants with international (non-Omani) high school certificates (e.g. Cambridge A-Level and Edexcel) need to obtain a letter of equivalency to their certificates from the Ministry of Education (MoE). For inquiries, you can refer to the MoE Website or contact the Admission Section at the contact provided at the end of this catalogue.

Students should note that the validity of these international tests is limited to two years from the date of taking the exam. Applicants must submit the original certificate of test results, and the University reserves the right to verify the authenticity of the certificate. Holders of IELTS and Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL) certificates issued by institutions outside Oman may be asked to take the CEPT.

Students who have been admitted to one of the DU UG academic programs but did not register for any reason, may reserve their admission for two academic years after which they have to reapply to join the university as a new student. However, if the entry requirements for the previously chosen program have changed during the time gap between the semester of admission and the semester of first registration of a new admitted student (maximum of 4 regular semesters), the admission will not be valid, and the admitted student must reapply according to the new program entry requirements.

Application Procedure

Every applicant is required to submit an **online** application through the DU Website (www.du.edu.om), along with uploading copies of the following color-scanned supporting documents:

- 1) A recent photograph
- 2) A valid passport in addition to the Omani visa page for non-Omanis.
- 3) The national identity card for Omanis OR residence card for non-Omanis.
- 4) A certified copy of the General Education Diploma Certificate or its equivalent
- 5) A non-refundable application fee of RO 30 for Diploma/Bachelor program. Payment can be made to the bank account of Dhofar University as mentioned in the online application.

It is important to note that any certificate that has been issued outside Oman must be authenticated by the Ministry of Education (MoE) for the high school certificate, and from the Ministry of Higher Education, Research and Innovation (MoHERI) for the Diploma and Bachelor's degree certificates for the transfer applicants.

Working students and students with disabilities should indicate their employment/disability status by ticking the designated boxes in their online application forms and uploading the supporting documents.

Transfer Students

Students who have started their studies in some other HEIs recognized by MoHERI, in or outside Oman, and wish to move and continue their study at DU can do so by applying with the required documents mentioned above in addition to their previous transcripts and course descriptions to DARSA (the Admission Section in the DAR).

Transfer Procedure

The transfer students are advised to apply as early as possible prior to the start of the semester, as announced in the academic calendar through the DU [Website](#), to get the course equivalency process done by the beginning of the registration period. It is important for transfer applicants to be aware that late applications might result in the postponement of their course registration to the following semester given that the equivalency process takes longer time if started less than two weeks towards the beginning of the semester.

Transfer students are admitted after the following conditions are satisfied:

- 1) they meet valid DU's admission requirements of the program of interest, and
- 2) they satisfy the residency requirements (for non-Omanis)

If any of the submitted documents is found to be fabricated, the University reserves the right to dismiss the student from the University with no obligations from its end.

Course Equivalency

A course taken for credit by a transfer student at another HEI before joining DU may be transferred to DU credit subject to the following conditions:

- 1) The relevant documents should be provided to DU at the time of admission for the first time. Students who bring documents for courses after starting their studies at DU will not be considered for equivalency.
- 2) The course is deemed equivalent to a course offered at DU, i.e. it covers 70% of its content, involves the same components (lecture, lab, tutorial), and has the same number of credits or more.
- 3) To be considered for equivalency the grade earned in the previous institution must be a minimum of PASS
- 4) At any circumstances, the number of transferred courses from another HEI must not exceed 50% of the total number of credit hours required for the academic program the student is applying to.
- 5) The course equivalency is normally in the same language e.g. English in English. However, the equivalency of non-English studied courses can be considered if an English Language proficiency certificate (i.e. IELTS minimum band 5.0) is provided at the time of admission. An Alternative English test might be provided at DU.

English Course Equivalency for IELTS

If a student has valid IELTS certification obtained from accredited and recognized centers in last Two years' period when applying for course equivalency for English course, the following rule of equivalency shall apply based on the IELTS total overall scores obtained:

IELTS scores	Course Equivalency
IELTS 5.5	ENGL 101
IELTS 6.0	ENGL 101, and ENGL 102
IELTS 6.5	ENGL 101, ENGL 102 and ENGL 203
IELTS 7.0	ENGL 101, ENGL 102, ENGL 203 and ENGL 204

Course Equivalency for EIDAAD Training Program

Students selected for EIDAAD Training Program shall be eligible for course equivalency based on the following conditions:

1. If a student successfully completes EIDAAD training for full two semesters, he will get six (6) Credit hours of equivalency against elective courses in his POS. In addition, she/he will be exempt from practical training included in his POS carrying Zero (0) Credit.
2. If a student finishes EIDAAD training for only one semester but doesn't want to complete he will get Zero (0) Credit. However, it will be considered as a practical training course (Pass/ Fail) no credit.
3. If a student's POS has practical training course with credits (E.g. 3 Credits), the exemption for practical training shall be given for any elective in the POS, subject to a maximum of six (6) credits in total.
4. Students are not allowed to register for courses while they are registered in EIDAAD program.
5. Evaluation criteria for EIDAAD Program: 75% weightage of the assessment from the industry supervisor, and 25% weightage of the assessment from the college supervisor (internal).

Residency Requirements

Students transferring to DU from another Higher Education Institution (HEI) must earn at least 50% of the total credits required for the academic program in which the student is enrolled at DU. That is, if the program total credit hours (CH) is 120, a transfer student can benefit from a maximum of 60 CH from the transferred credits. It is also important to know that only transferred courses that are counted towards the registered major will be considered within the 50% allowed.

Transferring within DU majors or colleges

A student may transfer from one major to another within the same college or to a different college after meeting the admission requirements of the new major and college at the time of transfer/change request. The student of this case should duly complete a "Change of Degree/ Major" form available on the SIS on the DU Website. This should be done at least one month before the beginning of the new semester.

Seeking a Second Degree

A student who already holds a Bachelor's (or Diploma) Degree and wishes to obtain a second Degree in a different major of study must complete, after admission to the new concerned college, all major credit hours as well as fulfill any other non-major graduation requirements for the new degree.

Studying Abroad

A DU student in good academic standing who did not transfer to DU from another HEI and wishes to study abroad must seek the approval of the College Council to spend up to one year and earn up to 30 credits at another HEI; however, the student must spend his/her final year of study at DU.

Visiting Students (through ICO)

As a part of DU efforts to enhance international profile, Dhofar University International Cooperation office (ICO) was established under the decision made by the Board of Directors and the VC Decision.

ICO promotes the internationalization of DU by:

- Strengthening activities of international cooperation
- Attracting and recruiting international students

Students can pursue one semester in the host institution through a reciprocal agreement between Dhofar University and partner universities abroad. Students from any of our partner universities are eligible to study at Dhofar University through an exchange program. The application and selection process for the exchange program is run entirely by the students' home university. International exchange students should apply through their institution's International Office. All such students shall be categorized as 'Visiting students' and shall be eligible to enroll at DU for up to TWO semesters. The academic rules of DU shall apply to them too. However, ICO should convey to the Home University the academic rules of DU and obtain their approval to facilitate the transfer of credits to the Visiting student transcript at the home institution.

Important Information for Transfer Applicants/Students!

Since the admission, change of major, and any other request made by the applicant (prospect or a current student) may result in major changes in terms of time, effort, and financial obligations, in addition to the possible change in the future career, it is essential for the applicant to be fully aware of the responsibility of such decision. It is, hence, necessary to the applicant to understand his/her responsibility to abide by all the concerned rules and regulations as laid by MoHERI and DU. Whereas an applicant's responsibility lies solely at his/her side with concern to the documents provided he/she provided, he/she shares equal responsibility with DU the responsibility of ensuring that MoHERI rules and regulations are followed. DU runs internal audits regularly besides applying various documents and procedures checks continually. Violations, when spotted, will be rectified to the maximum possible. This includes reverting violations, when spotted, will be corrected to the maximum possible. This includes reverting actions that were taken even when such corrective actions will prolong the remaining period of study and/or extra tuition fees.

PART B - THE FOUNDATION PROGRAM

The Foundation Program (FP) is delivered by The Centre for Preparatory Studies (CPS). The FP aims to prepare students for their post-secondary and higher education studies. It offers a one-year bridge course intended to equip high school graduates to pursue university majors. The program focuses on four areas: English, Mathematics, IT, and General Study Skills. The FP follows the general standards and learning outcomes as outlined by the Oman Academic Standards (OAS). It is outcome based and aims to impart quality education to students and prepare them for their various majors. With courses ranging from lower intermediate to upper intermediate, it caters to the curricular, co-curricular and extra-curricular needs of students to actively bridge the gap between secondary and college education.

English courses are offered in three levels. However, only one level is offered to students majoring in Law and Social Work in Arabic. Similarly, Mathematics and IT are offered in three levels, with only one level each for Law, Arabic and Social Work in Arabic students.

All FP students who fail the same level of English three times will be dropped from the program. Students dropped from the CPS are not allowed to register for the program again. However, students who manage to procure an IELTS certificate securing Band 5 will be allowed to proceed straight to college.

A student can progress to his/her major in the College only after successfully completing all FP requirements (English, Math and IT).

Placement in and Exemption from the FP

Students are placed in the appropriate level or exempted from the FP based on their results in the placement tests for English, Mathematics and IT as given below:

Placement Criteria for English		
Criterion	Level	Exemption Conditions
0-32	1	Students can be exempted from FP's English program if they fulfill anyone of the following conditions: 1. Score 50 & above on the Cambridge University Online Placement Test (CEPT) or 2. Produce an IELTS certificate with a band of 5+, or 3. Produce a TOEFL certificate indicating a score of 500+
33-42	2	
43-49	3	
50 and above	Exempt	

Placement Criteria for Mathematics		
Criterion	Level	Exemption Conditions
0-39	pre	Students can be exempted from FP's Mathematics program if they fulfill anyone of the following conditions: 1. Students who score 60 & above on the Moodle Based Mathematics Placement Test
40-49	1	
50-59	2	
60 and above	Exempt	

Placement Criteria for Information Technology (IT)		
Criterion	Level	Exemption Conditions
0-49	Pre	Students can be exempted from FP’s IT program if they fulfill anyone of the following conditions: 1. Score 70 & above on the Moodle-based IT Placement Test or 2. Provide an International (English) IC3, or Provide a Domestic (Arabic) IC3 or any other equivalent certificates AND score a minimum of 60% on an in-house IT Challenge Test.
50-59	1	
60-69	2	
70 and above	Exempt	
Note: External certifications such as IELTS, TOFEL and IC3 as mentioned are accepted from DU recognized Centers only.		

*The validity of these international tests is limited to **two years** from the date of taking the exam. Applicants must submit the original certificate of test results, and the University reserves the right to verify the authenticity of the certificate. Holders of IELTS and Test of English as a Foreign Language (TOEFL) certificates issued by institutions outside Oman may be asked to take the CEPT.

FP Study Duration

FP has THREE terms in each academic year. Each term has thirteen (13) weeks of intensive teaching and assessment.

FP Courses & levels

FP offers the three subjects in levels

1. The **English program** is divided into THREE levels and focuses on academic skills along with general study and communication skills.
2. The **Mathematics program** is divided into THREE levels as well, with Basic, Applied and Pure courses.
3. The **IT program** is comprised of TWO levels along with a pre-IT supporting level.

The table provide information on the levels in each subject, the hours of teaching in each week, the level to be taken to fulfill the FP requirements for UG programs taught in English or in Arabic.

Courses	Level	Hours per week	UG programs taught in English	UG programs Taught in ARABIC			
				LAW	Education	Social Works	Arabic
ENGLISH	1	20	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
	2	20	YES	NA			
	3	20	YES	NA			
Mathematics	Pre	4	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
	1	4	YES	NA			
	2	4	YES	NA			
IT	Pre	2	--	--	--	--	--
	1	4	YES	YES	YES	YES	YES
	2	4	YES	NA			

Pass Grade

The pass grade in each of the three courses is 50 at each level. Students scoring less than the pass grade must repeat the failed course(s) in the following terms:

Re-sit and Make up Exams

Students who FAIL in the final exams get a second chance of assessment to prove their ability of having achieved the stipulated learning outcomes through a re-sit exam. A student may be granted the permission based on a request petition for a re-sit of the final Exam by the CPS Director. The Make-up examination is given to those

students who are ABSENT during regular mid-term or final examinations and who have submitted a petition along with a valid excuse within the stipulated time for approval.

The re-sit/makeup exams will be conducted on the same day and at the same time for all the approved, eligible students/ absentees on the same course. If the student does not produce a valid excuse or does not report for the re-sit/ make-up exam, he /she will be given zero marks for that exam.

Promotion and Exit Policy

Oman Academic Standards for GFP require an exit assessment to determine whether a student has met the required GFP learning outcomes in four areas of learning viz English, Mathematics, Computing, and General study skills. FP has exit exams in place in the final levels of all 3 areas of learning, as general study skills are embedded in all the subjects. Level 3 English students and Level 2 Math and IT students are required to take exit exams in addition to their term-end exams.

Students can progress to their majors in the College only after successfully completing all FP requirements (English, Math and IT).

Students majoring in Architectural Engineering must score no less than 60% in English, Math and IT to be able to proceed to college.

Challenge Test

A challenge test is provided as an alternative route to pass one or more FP levels in any of the FP modules English, Math, or IT. Qualifying for the challenge test is subject to the following conditions:

1. No level-one students can qualify for this test.
2. Level-two and Level-three students have the option to sit for the challenge test if they meet the following conditions:
 - a. They must score at least 95 out of 100 in the previous level in the target course.
 - b. They must achieve a minimum score of 8 out of 10 in the short general writing test.
 - c. They must score no less than 70 out of 100 in the comprehensive exam covering the content of the target level of the course.

PART C - REGISTRATION

Registration

The registration process involves students selecting the courses to be undertaken by her/him in a particular normal semester, based on the PoS and under advice from the academic advisor and enrolling in them formally. DARSA shall announce in advance through the DU Student Information System (SIS), the academic calendar containing information about the course offering, timetable and the registration period and schedule. The SIS also contains information about the course descriptions to help students understand the course content.

Usually, the periods of registration are announced in the academic calendar, which is published on the DU Website and advertised through official communication and social media.

Students may be prevented from registering in courses based on the following:

1. Specific academic pre-requisites are not met.
2. Lack of seats, timetable conflicts, outstanding fees
3. Missing the University Requirement courses required credits as per their PoS.
4. Academic or disciplinary sanctions.
5. Registering for more or less than the normal load

The University reserves the right to cancel registration in courses/sections where:

1. There is insufficient enrolment in a course offered at a specific time.
2. the course timing conflicts with other core courses
3. courses are specifically meant for specific group of students (e.g. Disabled students).
4. sections that are reserved for employed students.

DARSA usually prioritize registration for:

1. Final year students who require access to a course to graduate.
2. Students who require pre-requisite courses in their Major area of study.

Dropping and Adding Courses

DU follows the credit hour system where students register for a certain number of credits per semester. A student is given an opportunity to choose his/her courses with the help of an academic advisor before or during the registration period. Students should use the advanced online registration system of DU to register and make any Drop/Add operation. However, if for any reason, the online facility was not possible, the student has an opportunity to make changes during the Add-and-Drop period by an Online Petition to his college stating his inability to register online.

Drop-and-Add Period

The drop and add period is announced in the DU academic calendar. Only the courses that remain in the schedule after the add-and-drop period will appear on the student's permanent academic record and transcript.

Waiting List Feature

During the online registration, if the selected schedule by a student cannot reach the minimum load for registration (12 credit hours), the waiting list (WL) facility will come to help students to register the courses they have selected and have less than 12 credit hours in total which is, in fact, a way to place a request to their academic departments to register for courses that are needed by them (according to their PoS). WL is available when the eligible courses/sections are either full or have conflict with the other selected courses/sections. If such a case is faced by a student, a "WL" appears in his/her temporary registration schedule stating the request status. Therefore, the WL courses are not considered registered until the Heads of Departments make decisions about them relying on set criteria. The schedule of study for a student will be the one that does not have any WL code which will be available in the beginning of the first week of study.

If a "WL" remains in a student's schedule after the Add-and-Drop period ends, he/she should notify his/her academic advisor, the Chairperson of the concerned course, or go to the Department of Admission and Registration to handle it.

Credit Load

- 1) A full-time student should register for not less than 12 credits and not more than 15 credits (18 for engineering and Law students) in any regular (Fall and Spring) semester.
- 2) A student may register for up to 18 credits (19 for engineering and Law students) if he/she has a cumulative average of at least 80 or a semester average of 80 for two consecutive semesters. However, the approval of the college is required for cases beyond these conditions.

- 3) Credit for incomplete courses will be included in the semester in which the incomplete courses were taken. The evaluation for that semester will be carried out as soon as the grades for the incomplete courses have been finalized.

Summer Semester Load and Registration

- 1) A student can register for a summer semester for a maximum of six credit hours.
- 2) There will be no academic status (probation) for the summer semester. The student's academic status will remain as it was in the previous semester.

Summer semester registration is normally restricted to

1. Final year students with up to nine credits left for graduating.
2. Students whose degree plans include summer courses.

Visiting Students

DU accepts students of other HEIs who would like to take a certain number of courses and transfer their credits to their universities. DU allows them to register for courses as special students. These students are required to present documents that show their credentials and preparedness from their previous university to take courses in the University.

Class Attendance and Absence Rules

Attendance of all classes and course-related activities is obligatory. The maximum absences allowed for a student is 25% of the total number of sessions of a particular course which include all excuses related to medical emergencies, self-illness, bereavement of a first degree relative, birth, delivery, or any other reason. Before reaching the withdrawal stage, DU system warns the students by way of **three** warnings sent to their DU email account by DARSA.

The warnings of absences are as follows:

- 1) **First warning:** this is when a student's absence reaches **7%** of the total number of sessions of a particular course.
- 2) **Second warning:** this is when a student's absence reaches **14%** of the total number of sessions of a particular course.
- 3) **Third (Final) warning:** this is when a student's absences reach **21%** of the total number of sessions of a particular course.

If the absence crosses 25%, the student will be dismissed from the course and a "WA" will be shown in his/her transcript against the dismissed course and dismissal letter will be sent to his DU email account. It is expected of all students to be self-responsible about their absences from classes and should make efforts to get the learning resources/lecture notes of missed classes to be aware of what has been taught in the missed classes. If a student is continuously absent from all courses without notification for more than 25% of the semester, s/he will have "WA" in all his courses.

Removal of WA

In case the students have valid excuses for her/his absences, she/he can file an online general petition attaching the evidence for the absences only once per course in a semester. The college council shall discuss the issue and take a decision to accept the request and inform the student as well as DARSA of its decision. The petition must be filed by the student within one week of getting the WA notification on the SIS system and shall be time-barred if filed after this period.

Withdrawal from a Course

A student may withdraw from one or more courses after the Drop-and-Add period subject to the following conditions:

- 1) Students cannot withdraw or be withdrawn from a course after the announced deadline in the academic calendar (not later than 14 weeks from the start of the semester or the number of the week in the Summer Term as mentioned in the academic calendar).
- 2) Students cannot withdraw or be forced to withdraw from a course if this results in his/her being registered for less than 12 credits without the approval of his College Council after consultation with DARSA.

Students who withdraw from a course are given a grade of "W", but those whose absences exceed 25% will receive a grade of "WA".

Withdrawal from a Semester

A student can apply to withdraw from a semester at any time after the Add-and-Drop period until the deadline of withdrawal as set in the Academic Calendar, using the Clearance and Withdrawal forms on the DU SIS. A student can withdraw from a semester if he/she does not exceed the maximum period allowed to study the

program, i.e. eight years for a bachelor program and four years for the diploma program. When a student returns to the university after semester withdrawal (for one semester or more), he/she should fill in and submit a 'Resumption of Study Form' for this purpose through the DU SIS.

Postponement of a Semester

A student can apply to postpone a semester at any time up to the last day of the Add-and-Drop period using the Clearance and Postponement forms on the DU SIS. A student can postpone a semester if he/she does not exceed the maximum period allowed to study the program, i.e. eight years for bachelor program and four years for the diploma program. When a student returns to the university after semester postponement (for one semester or more), he/she should submit a 'Resumption of Study Form' for this purpose through the DU SIS.

Dismissal

A student who does not meet the required terms and conditions of good academic standing or a student who commits disruptive actions shall be dismissed from the University.

The disruptive actions may include:

1. Attempts to disrupt the University's cultural, literary and other activities.
2. Acts that violate honor, dignity, ethics or religious beliefs.
3. Assault, threat or disrespect against any member of the University community.

Unofficial Withdrawal

Students will be considered to have withdrawn unofficially if they:

1. did not register after being initially admitted in the University, or
2. do not register by the end of the Drop & Add period of each regular semester with no information to the university, or
3. are continuously absent from all courses without notification for more than 25% of the semester.
4. Unofficially withdrawn semester is counted as official withdrawal in terms of the maximum period of study allowed.

Withdrawal from the University

A student may apply to withdraw from the University by submitting an online Petition (Clearance) available on the DU SIS/DU Website after consulting his academic advisor. In certain cases, the DARSA may act on behalf of the student in completing the withdrawal process. Typically, this would occur in cases involving death, serious injury, illness, or formal requests to do so.

Disclosure Policy

The University may disclose general information without prior written consent from the student and this information may include only: student's name, degrees granted, major and minor fields of study, awards received and participation in official activities and sports.

However, the University shall not release other information from academic records, unless it receives the written consent of the student, and this written consent must specify the information that is to be disclosed, the purpose of the disclosure, and the names and addresses of the individuals or institutions to whom disclosure is to be made.

However, the University may disclose information, including information on academic records, without prior consent of the student in the following cases:

- 1) Upon the request of officers of the MoHERI or any other educational institutions where the student seeks to enroll (in such cases the student will be given, upon his/her request, a copy of the information sent to the institution.);
- 2) As requested by the students' sponsors.
- 3) As necessary to academic officers, academic advisors, and faculty members within the University,
- 4) In compliance with a judicial order; and
- 5) To financial aid services in connection with financial aid for which the student has applied or has received.

PART D - FEES AND EXPENSES

SIS Account

Every DU student has an SIS account which also provides information on student fees paid and outstanding. It also includes a window to facilitate tuition fee online payment.

Student Category

1. **Private Student** - A private student is one who bears and pays the entire tuition fee of the enroll program for her/himself.
2. **Scholarship Students** – A scholarship student is one who has approved scholarship either from MOHERI or other sponsors for the entire academic program or part of it. The tuition fees are therefore paid by MOHERI or other Sponsors.

Tuition Fees

Tuition fees are as follows:

Programs	Fee per Credit Hour
All Undergraduate Programs as existed in 2023/2024	OMR 70
All new UG programs starting 2024/2025 (except the MD program).	OMR 80

The above tuition fees do not include books, transportation or registration fees.

Tuition Fees Refund

A **private student** may withdraw from a semester after registration, but the refund of tuition fees (excluding the registration fees) depends on the timing of the withdrawal:

1. Full tuition fees will be refunded only to those students who withdraw from the semester before the end of the first week of classes.
2. 50% of tuition fees will be refunded to those students who withdraw before the end of the second week of classes.
3. NO REFUND to be made to students who withdraw from the semester from the beginning of the third week of classes onwards.

A private student can also petition DU for a fee refund based on a very exceptional excuse which is evaluated by a DU Student Special Cases Committee to accept or reject the petition. A scholarship student's fees are paid by a sponsor or MOHERI and their rules and conditions apply.

Tuition Fees Carried Forward

The tuition fee paid by a private student for registered course which are duly "DROPED" within the Add and Drop period without replacement, shall be carried forward to the next semester and would be adjusted against registration for course in that semester.

Financial Hold

Students who have arrears of their tuition fee for course registered shall not be able to access the final grades till they clear their outstanding dues and will only see 'FIN HOLD' in the DU SIS account.

Outstanding Due of fee

Every student must clear all outstanding semester fees to be eligible for registration in the subsequent semester. All graduated students are required to clear all outstanding fees before they can be issued their degree certificate.

PART E - COURSES AND GRADING

Grading System

The undergraduate grading system adopted at DU and its equivalence to the Letter Grade system and the Grade Points Average (GPA) system are shown below:

Numerical Grades	Grades Type	Equivalent Letter Grades	Equivalent Grade Points	Grade Description
95-100	Excellent	A	4.0	Demonstrates an excellent understanding of all the course learning outcomes. The student's performance in all the set outcomes exceeds the set expectations.
90-94		A-	3.7	
87-89	Very Good	B+	3.3	Demonstrates a very good understanding of all the course learning outcomes. The student's performance in most of the set outcomes exceeds the set expectations.
83-86		B	3.0	
80-82		B-	2.7	
77-79	Good	C+	2.3	Demonstrates a good understanding of the course learning outcomes. Few students' weak learning areas do not undermine her/his good work.
73-76		C	2.0	
70-72		C-	1.7	
65-69	Pass	D+	1.3	Demonstrates an acceptable bear minimum grasp of the course learning outcomes. The student's weak learning areas are not significant to stop her/his progress.
60-64		D	1.0	
Below 60	Fail	F	0.0	Inability to achieve most of the learning outcomes of the course. Retaking the course is required.

Abbreviations

Incomplete	I
Pass	P
In Progress	PR
Pending	PND
Withdrawal	W
Withdrawn for Excessive Absence	WA
Fail	F
No Grade Reported	-
Pass Transferred	PT
Exempted	EX
Granted	GR
Not Counted	NC

Students' Academic Assessments

A student's academic performance is assessed throughout the semester using various instruments: homework, exams, research papers, projects, practical works, etc. The student has the right to receive continuous feedback about his/her performance. The instructor completes a through-the-term performance assessment to give students a chance to withdraw from the course before the end of the withdrawal period and to help academic advisors to better advise students for the next semester registration.

Normally, all courses have final examinations that students must take. The instructor announces the course syllabus at the beginning of the semester where course components and associated assessment criteria are clearly stated. The course components and their allotted grades comply with the University policies.

Incomplete Work - “I”

A student who misses the final exam shall receive a grade of zero for the final exam weight. However, if the student makes a petition (through the DU website) with a valid excuse for his/her absence, and the petition is approved, a grade of incomplete ‘I’ would be posted on the student’s record.

Normally, no incomplete grade of “I” is given as a final grade in any course. In exceptional cases, and provided the guidelines stated below are met, a student may be allowed to make up the incomplete work. These guidelines are:

- 1) For securing permission to complete the work for a course, a student must submit an online “incomplete petition” with a valid excuse up to two weeks from the last day of the scheduled examination for that semester. Students should be aware that approval is not automatically granted.
- 2) Students permitted to complete the work for a course must do so in the first week of the start of the immediate next semester. However, incomplete work of Spring semester can be completed within one week of Fall semester.
- 3) After the incomplete work is done and evaluated, the course instructor submits a “change of grade petition” electronically which will be approved by the chairperson, college dean and will be received by DARSA who will affect the change in the grade.
- 4) If no valid excuse is presented or the work, if permitted, is not completed within the time limit specified above, the “I” will be replaced with numeric grade scored that becomes the final grade in the course.

Announcement of Final Grades

Upon the conclusion of the final exams, DARSA announces the final grades through the DU SIS system. Students can view their grades in both the transcript format and the PoS format by accessing their DU SIS accounts.

Petition for Reviewing the Final Exam Grade

Any student who feels that the grading was unfair, must promptly discuss the matter with the course instructor. If the student and the instructor are unable to arrive at a solution, the student can submit an online “Grade Review” petition available on the DU Website up to one week from the end of the final exams period.

The Department Chairperson of the course concerned investigates the student's arguments and may request the College Council to review the instructor's evaluation of the student. If the grade is due for change, an approved changed grade is sent by the same Review Grade petition form electronically by the instructor which is approved by the chairperson, and the college dean/assistant dean and is received by DARSA who implements the change in the grade received.

Change of Grade

Normally, grades cannot be changed after the submission of the final grades to the DARSA. Under exceptional circumstances as mentioned above, the Course Instructor submits, electronically, an approved “Change-of-Grade Form” to the DARSA stating the reasons for the change and endorsed by the Department Chairperson and the Dean's Office (dean/assistant dean) of the College. The DARSA should receive the approved “Change of Grade form” up to two (2) weeks from the beginning of the following semester.

Academic Achievements

To be placed on the Dean's Honor List at the end of a given Fall or Spring semester, a student must:

- 1) Be carrying at least 12 credits
- 2) Never been on probation
- 3) Have passed all the courses of the semester and attained a semester average of 90 or more
- 4) Have finished at least 24 credits
- 5) Have not been subject to any disciplinary action within the University, and be deemed worthy by the Dean to be on the Honor List

Failing Courses

If a student fails a course, no re-sit examination is permitted. A student who fails a required course must repeat the course at the earliest opportunity. A student who fails an elective course may not have to repeat it as long as he/she can achieve the minimum cumulative average, and the minimum number of credits required for graduation. A student must pass all core courses to be eligible for graduation. Please read the “Academic Dismissal” section for related important information.

Repeating Courses

- 1) A student may repeat any course for which he/she received a grade of less than 70.
- 2) When a course is repeated, the highest grade will be considered in the calculation of the CGPA. All course grades will remain a part of the student's permanent record.
- 3) A student who, at the end of her/his fourth year, fails to attain CGPA of 65%, will be required to repeat courses in which the student has scored low grades.

Academic Standing

Based on the academic program, an undergraduate student shall be considered to have completed one or more academic years based on the number of credit hours completed successfully by him/her as shown below:

- 1) For completion of the first year: 30 to 38 credits.
- 2) For completion of the second year: 60 to 75 credits.
- 3) For completion of the third year: 90 to 104 credits.
- 4) For completion of the fourth year: 120 to 150 credits.

Academic Probation (for College Students)

The academic probation system applies to the students at their college level. The following rules apply:

- 1) A diploma or a bachelor student is placed under "Academic Probation" if his/her SGPA is less than 65% at the end of the first or any subsequent semester.
- 2) The probationary status of a student shall be removed when he/she attains a SGPA of 65% or more in the second or any subsequent semester.
- 3) If a student falls again on probationary status, her/his probation will continue from where it stopped. In other words, clearing a probationary status will not restart it from First Probation. This does not apply when the student changes her/his major.

A Diploma degree student can be placed on "Academic Probation" for a maximum of two times, while a bachelor's degree student can be placed on "Academic Probation" for a maximum of three times. For the diploma degree student, the sequence of probation is: first probation and strict (final) probation. Likewise, for the bachelor's degree student, the sequence of probation is: first probation, second probation and strict (final) probation.

It is important for students under probation to be aware that they are not allowed to register for more than 12 credit hours. In addition, students who fall on an academic probationary status will have to sign an undertaking of their acknowledgement of their status, its associated conditions, and the consequences in case they have not cleared it.

Academic Dismissal

A student may be dismissed from a major, college or DU for any of the following reasons:

- 1) If he/she fails to clear her/his strict academic probation which is the final stage in academic probation, excluding the summer term. The dismissal from a major, college or DU depends on the student's specific problem which should be determined by the college council based on the advisor's opinion. The advisor's opinion builds on the nature of the dismissal. That is, if the student is dismissed because of a major required course then the dismissal should be from the major. If, otherwise, the probation was caused by a particular failure in a college required course, then the dismissal should be from the college and the student should change college.
- 2) A student who is dismissed from a major can change it to another major within or to another college. A student who is dismissed from a college should change college.
- 3) If he/she fails in any university requirement course a total of four times. A student can be dismissed for this reason even if he/she is in the final year at DU. When a student is dismissed from DU because of this reason, he/she cannot resume at DU in any program or college till he/she passes the same/similar course (approved by the Chairperson of the department) from other recognized HEI.

However, the academic advisor may recommend a different solution to the above-given ones if s/he deems it more reasonable. The recommended solution should be approved by the college and approved by DARSA.

PART F - GRADUATION REGULATIONS

Degree Plan

The requirements for completing a degree (academic program) are stated in the student's plan of study (PoS). Even though the PoS of one program is different from another, all these PoS for undergraduate programs share the same structure of the course distribution as given below.

University Requirements (URs)

This includes courses that are common for all programs across DU Colleges. These courses aim to provide essential knowledge and skills that are required to be acquired by all DU students. The courses of this category must be completed by all students of DU.

The total number of "University Requirements" for bachelor's program is 12 credits.

The University Requirement courses are:

- 1) ARAB101: Academic Writing in Arabic
- 2) ENGL101: Basic Academic English
- 3) ENTR 200: Entrepreneurship: Innovation and Creativity
- 4) SOCS102: Omani Society

College Requirements (CRs)

This includes courses that are common among the students at the same college only. The number of credit hours differs based on the degree level and the program's nature. The courses of this category must be completed by all students who belong to the same college. These are mentioned under the program and college on the college concerned website.

Major Requirements (MRs)

Students of the same major must study a specific group of courses that differ according to the major and level of the degree. The courses of this category must be completed by all students who belong to the same major. These are mentioned under the program and college on the concerned college website.

Elective Requirements (ERs)

This category is only available at the bachelor level where students have the freedom to select from some courses within the required number of credits allotted for this category. Under this category there are one or more of the following subcategories: general electives, social electives, college electives and major electives. These are mentioned under the program and college on the college concerned website.

Graduation Requirements

Diploma Degree

To receive a Diploma, students must satisfy the following conditions:

1. Satisfactorily complete 60 - 75 credit hours, depending on the program.
2. Achieve a minimum cumulative average of 65 percent.
3. Fulfil any additional requirement specified by the degree Plan
4. Clear all encumbrance from all concerned University Units.

Bachelor Degree

To receive a bachelor's degree, a student must satisfy the following conditions:

- 1) Complete the total number of credits required for the program which ranges from 120 up to 150 credits based on the major.
- 2) Achieve a minimum cumulative average of 65 percent.
- 3) Fulfil any additional requirement specified by the degree Plan
- 4) Clear all encumbrance from all concerned University Units.

Course Substitution

A substitute course is not an equivalent course. A substitute course is used to replace a required course from an academic program PoS and should only be used when there is no other possible means to maintain the PoS without affecting the student's expected date of graduation for a student. An example of the reason can be an original course is not offered in the semester schedule due to a phasing out of a program PoS. Another example is when there is an unavoidable timetable conflict for a student in his final academic semester.

In such a circumstance, the below conditions apply:

1. The total number of credits that can be substituted in a student's PoS is six (6).
2. The course(s) to be substituted is(are) not (a) major requirement course.
3. The substitute course should be at the same academic level as the original course or higher (e.g. year 4 standing).
4. The number of credit hours for the substitute course shall be equal or higher to those of the course required in the study plan.
5. The substituted course should be delivered in the same medium of instruction as the original course.
6. All course substitution scenarios mentioned above require student's College Council approval after a formal consultation with DARSA.

Study Period

All enrolled students in various degree plans are expected to complete their degree requirements within a reasonable time frame as defined below:

Degree Plan	Usual Duration	Maximum Duration
Diploma	2 years	4 years
Bachelor	4 Years	8 Years

However, if the student joins in second or third year as transfer student, the maximum period will be proportionately reduced. Students are strongly advised to consult their academic advisor to make sure they are progressing within their specific time frame.

Changes to Approved Degree Plan

Every effort is made to maintain the program of study described in the approved degree plan. However, changing circumstances may require a minor revision/change to that approved degree plan. Such changes must be approved by the Department/College council and finally by the MoHERI. All such changes will be announced to students and staff concerned. These changes are binding on students in terms of graduation requirements. Students repeating a failed course are bound by any revision to course content, credits, or hours made to that course.

Resumption of study

If a student returns after a period of interruption to complete her/his degree program, or, study another program, the following scenarios apply subject to the corresponding circumstances mentioned for each scenario:

S.N.	Period of Interruption*	PoS, changed?	Action**
1	Up to 3 semesters	No	DU ID remains the same. No change to the student's original PoS.
2		Yes	DU ID remains the same. PoS is updated to the latest one. A different possible action to the students PoS might be proposed by the academic advisor if believed to better suit the student. The proposal needs the college council and DARSA approval.
3	4 (or more) semesters	No	The student has a "Lost Seat" status. A new DU ID is issued. No change to the student's original PoS.
4		Yes	The student has a "Lost Seat" status. A new DU ID is issued. PoS is normally updated to the latest one. A different possible action to the students PoS might be proposed by the academic advisor if believed to better suit the student. The proposal needs the college council and DARSA approval.

* Does not include the Summer Term

** All scenarios do not violate the program's maximum period of study mentioned above.

Classification of Degrees

Following the grading system of DU, academic degrees awarded are classified based on the Cumulative Average (CGPA) earned on all courses within the degree plan. The student cumulative average upon graduation will follow the same grading system mentioned above.

Cumulative Average (%)	Equivalent Grade Points (CGPA)	Equivalent Letter Grades	Grades Type	Cumulative Average Description
90 - 100	3.7-4.0	A	Excellent	Demonstrates an excellent understanding of all the program learning outcomes. The student's performance in all the set outcomes exceeds the set expectations.
80 - 89	2.7-3.3	B	Very Good	Demonstrates a very good understanding of all the program learning outcomes. The student's performance in most of the set outcomes exceeds the set expectations.
70 - 79	1.7-2.3	C	Good	Demonstrates a good understanding of the program learning outcomes. Few students' weak learning areas do not undermine her/his good work.
65 - 69	1.3	D	Pass	Demonstrates an acceptable bear minimum grasp of the program learning outcomes. The student's weak learning areas are not significant to stop her/his progress.

ACADEMIC SUPPORT

DU provides all its students with all academic support to excel in their academic efforts and help hone their employability skills. Various centers and units are providing all academic support to the students to excel in their academic pursuit.

Learning Support Center (LSC)-

Learning Support Center (LSC) at DU aims for providing personalized academic assistance in a professional and supportive atmosphere to:

1. all students in general to develop their knowledge base, academic skills, and strategies to help them become confident, independent and lifelong learners to succeed in their studies.
2. academically weak students and students with disabilities, through a peer-assisted learning scheme to motivate them and provide them with extra support so that they can also cope with the pressure of higher education and perform well.
3. special and personalized learning support through a range of individual consultation, peer tutoring, workshops, presentations and other programs.

Students With Disabilities Unit (SDU)

DU has set up a special Unit to cater to the students with disabilities who aspire to acquire academic degrees. The unit's objectives are:

1. To provide comprehensive support services to persons with disabilities suitable to their educational needs.
2. To supply all suitable physical facilities to the persons with disabilities on campus which ensures easy and comfortable electronic and spatial cognitive access.
3. Develop the skills of persons with disabilities aligned with their potentials and disabilities.
4. To provide standard and clear criteria-based social, psychological and learning support services for persons with disabilities.
5. To support persons with disabilities through establishing smart partnerships with the public sector and private sector.
6. To support research and studies that focus on the needs and challenges encountered by persons with disabilities and the ways for empowering them and developing their abilities.
7. To integrate the persons with disabilities into the students' community and activities.

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